

ProQuESS ENGINEERING & INDUSTRIAL CONSULTING

PROCESS. QUALITY. EHS SYSTEMS. ENGINEERED AS ONE.

Zero-Defect Engineering for a Zero-Tolerance Industry

Premium Process Engineering, Quality Management Systems, EHS & Process Safety Frameworks — operating as one integrated system.

Market Focus

Kingdom of Saudi Arabia,
GCC, Sub-Saharan & North
Africa

Sector Focus

Refining, Petrochemicals,
Fertilizers, Specialty
Chemicals, Water Treatment,
Heavy Process Industries

Standards Portfolio

API 610/ISO 13709, ASME
B31.3, ASME Sec. VIII Div. 1,
ISA-75/IEC 60534, TEMA, ISO
9001, ISO/IEC 17025, IEC
61882, SAES, SABIC

Core Promise: Eliminate Downtime. Eliminate Variance. Eliminate Calibration Drift. Where Process Engineering, Quality Governance, and Process Safety Operate as One System.

A Letter to Plant Directors, Technical Managers, and Operations Leadership in the US, GCC, and Africa

ProQuESS was founded on a principle that the most demanding process industries have always understood but rarely addressed with the rigor it demands: operational failure is not random. It is the cumulative result of undetected engineering drift, undocumented quality variance, and deferred safety governance — compounding quietly until a single event forces the issue. Whether that event is an unplanned shutdown, a regulatory non-conformance, or a field incident, the root causes were present long before the crisis arrived. The question is whether your organization has the systems in place to detect and correct those root causes before they become liabilities.

The three pillars below represent the most common — and most costly — sources of operational degradation in refining, petrochemical, and heavy process industries. They are not isolated problems. They are interconnected symptoms of a broader gap in integrated operational governance. ProQuESS addresses all three simultaneously, because that is how they must be solved.

The True Cost of Plant Downtime

Pumps operating near NPSH margins, control valves at 92% travel, and heat exchanger fouling — each representing a silent erosion of operational uptime and financial performance that compounds with every unplanned shutdown. These are not emergency conditions. They are chronic conditions that go undetected until they trigger an event. The financial impact is not limited to the shutdown itself; it extends to accelerated asset degradation, reduced MTBR, and the operational cost of reactive maintenance across an entire pump or exchanger fleet.

The Hidden Cost of Variance

Out-of-Specification laboratory results without systematic action paths create regulatory exposure and erode customer confidence. Without documented investigation and closure protocols, variance becomes a recurring operational liability rather than a solvable engineering problem. In regulated markets — particularly under Saudi Aramco, SABIC, and US EPA frameworks — undocumented OOS outcomes carry direct consequences for vendor pre-qualification, product certification, and audit standing. The cost is not just operational; it is reputational and contractual.

The Critical Risk of Calibration Drift

Deferred preventive maintenance and vendor qualification failures for Saudi Aramco and SABIC trace directly to instrumentation drift that goes undetected — until it triggers audit non-conformances, failed pre-qualifications, or field incidents. Calibration drift is not a laboratory problem. It is a process safety problem. When safety instrumented systems, custody transfer meters, and environmental monitors are not maintained to verified traceability standards, the entire operational envelope is compromised. ProQuESS builds calibration governance into the operational system, not as a periodic exercise but as a continuous discipline.

③ ProQuESS integrates three pillars — **[Pro]** Process Engineering Suite, **[Qu]** Quality Management SOP Frameworks, and **[ESS]** EHS & Process Safety Frameworks — into a living, field-ready operational ecosystem built to withstand regulatory and technical bid scrutiny across the US, GCC, and African markets.

Converting Engineering Calculation into Financial and Operational Value

Process engineering governed by Aspen Plus/HYSYS simulation data and API 610, ASME B31.3, ISA-75, and TEMA standards is not an academic exercise. It is the foundation of operational predictability. Every hydraulic recalculation, every thermal duty verification, and every control valve sizing analysis carries a direct financial translation — reduced energy consumption, extended equipment life, unlocked throughput capacity, and the conversion of unplanned derates into planned, scheduled maintenance events. The difference between an organization that performs these calculations and one that does not is measured in MTBR, energy cost per unit, and unplanned downtime hours per year.

The table below maps the most common simulation parameters to their engineering translations and their operational value. Each row represents a field intervention that ProQuESS engineers execute as part of a standard diagnostic or optimization engagement — translating raw simulation data into documented, auditable, financially justified engineering actions.

Simulation Parameter	Engineering Translation	Operational Value
NPSHa vs. NPSHr Margins	Cavitation margin analysis on centrifugal pumps	Extended Mean Time Between Repair (MTBR)
Total Dynamic Head (TDH)	Hydraulic recalculation and pump curve verification	Reduced energy inefficiency and motor loading
Control Valve Travel Range	Cv sizing and installed characteristic analysis	Unlocking hidden throughput capacity
Exchanger Fouling Prediction	Thermal duty recalculation and UA trending	Converting unplanned derates into planned maintenance

Case Illustration: The 5% NPSH Margin

The hidden cost of a 5% NPSH margin on centrifugal pumps — a margin that appears acceptable on paper but accelerates impeller damage, reduces MTBR, and drives unplanned maintenance events across a pump fleet. In a typical refining application, a pump fleet operating at marginal NPSH conditions can experience impeller erosion rates 3–4× higher than design baseline, translating directly to increased repair frequency, spare parts consumption, and unplanned downtime. ProQuESS NPSH margin audits identify these conditions before they become failures — and document the financial case for corrective intervention with the precision that technical bid evaluators and operations leadership require.

Pillar [ESS]: HAZOP Leadership as a Risk-Reduction Investment

HAZOP studies conducted under IEC 61882 link process causes to verified design parameters and track every recommendation through the Pillar [Qu] CAPA Master Log — closing the loop between hazard identification and documented corrective action. This is not a compliance checkbox. It is an operational governance mechanism that ensures no HAZOP recommendation is lost, no corrective action is undocumented, and no process hazard remains open without a verified closure path. For organizations undergoing Saudi Aramco pre-qualification, SASO/NCEC inspection, or US EPA audit, this closed-loop HAZOP-to-CAPA linkage is a demonstrable differentiator in technical bid evaluation.

IEC 61882

HAZOP

CAPA MASTER LOG

OOS/CAPA Frameworks and Smart Criticality Matrices

ProQuESS Two-Phase Out-of-Specification (OOS) Investigation Framework, aligned with ISO/IEC 17025:2017, is designed to transform laboratory variance from a regulatory liability into a structured, traceable, and auditable engineering process. In regulated process industries — particularly those serving Saudi Aramco, SABIC, and US EPA-monitored operations — an undocumented OOS outcome is not merely a quality issue. It is a contractual and regulatory exposure that can trigger vendor disqualification, product rejection, and audit non-conformance. The ProQuESS framework ensures that every OOS event is investigated, documented, dispositioned, and closed with full accountability and traceability across all operational disciplines.

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Phase 1: 24-Hour Laboratory Investigation Checklist Sample integrity verification, Analyst and Procedure review, Reagents and Standards check, Instrument Verification status, and Environmental Conditions assessment — all completed within a 24-hour window from OOS detection. This rapid-response phase isolates laboratory error from process-related causes before the investigation expands into cross-functional territory. Speed matters: the faster the laboratory phase is closed, the faster the process investigation can begin, and the lower the regulatory exposure window.	Phase 2: Process Investigation & OOS Disposition Cross-Functional Trend Registers and OOS Disposition Outcomes: Confirmed Lab Error, Confirmed Process Related, or Indeterminate — with a Five-Level Sign-Off Sequence ensuring full accountability and traceability. Each disposition carries a defined action path, a documented closure protocol, and a CAPA entry that feeds into the Unified Master Log. No OOS outcome is closed without verified sign-off from all responsible parties — laboratory, operations, quality, and engineering.	Unified CAPA Master Log Core tracking fields with automated trend flags to prevent recurrence and support regulatory audit readiness across all operational disciplines. The CAPA Master Log is the central governance document that links every OOS event, every HAZOP recommendation, every calibration deviation, and every audit finding into a single, searchable, auditable system. For organizations undergoing Saudi Aramco vendor pre-qualification or SASO/NCEC inspection, the CAPA Master Log is the primary evidence of operational governance maturity.

Smart Equipment Criticality Matrix

The ProQuESS Smart Equipment Criticality Matrix applies a 5-category impact scoring system that maps every instrument and measurement point to an explicit field action and a 4:1 Test Uncertainty Ratio (TUR). This is not a generic criticality ranking. It is a field-ready classification that drives calibration intervals, maintenance priorities, and audit documentation requirements — ensuring that the highest-risk instruments receive the highest level of governance attention and traceability.

SIS / SIL Safety Instrumented Systems — highest criticality. Mandatory calibration intervals, verified traceability, and documented SIL verification. No deferral permitted without formal Management of Change (MOC) approval.	Quality Product specification and laboratory measurement integrity. Direct impact on OOS outcomes, customer certification, and regulatory compliance. 4:1 TUR required for all primary measurement instruments.	Custody Transfer Financial metering and custody measurement accuracy. Direct financial exposure. Calibration drift in custody transfer systems translates directly to revenue loss or contractual dispute. Highest audit scrutiny level.
Environment Emissions, effluent, and environmental compliance monitoring. Regulatory exposure under EPA, NCEC, and GCC environmental frameworks. Non-compliance carries financial penalties and operational restrictions.	Availability Production uptime and equipment reliability impact. Instruments in this category directly affect MTBR, unplanned downtime frequency, and maintenance cost per unit. Optimizing this category delivers the highest ROI on calibration investment.	

The ProQuESS Four-Phase Engagement Pipeline

Every ProQuESS engagement follows a structured four-phase pipeline designed to ensure that engineering optimization is never disconnected from quality governance and process safety. The three pillars — [Pro], [Qu], and [ESS] — operate as one system throughout the engagement lifecycle. Each phase builds on the previous, creating a cumulative operational capability that is documented, auditable, and transferable to your internal teams. This is not a consulting engagement that ends with a report. It is an operational transformation that ends with your team fully capable of sustaining the systems independently.

Phase I: Diagnostic Technical Audit

Duration: 2–4 Weeks

Establishing process engineering, quality/metrology, and process safety baselines to deliver a comprehensive Gap Analysis Report. This phase identifies all engineering, quality, and safety gaps against applicable standards — API 610, ASME B31.3, ISO/IEC 17025, IEC 61882, SAES, and SABIC requirements — and quantifies the operational and financial impact of each gap. The Gap Analysis Report is the foundation document for all subsequent phases.

Phase III: System Integration & Handover

Duration: 3–6 Weeks

Activating **Loop A** (Sampling Chain of Custody), **Loop B** (OOS to Manufacturing Adjustment), **Loop C** (Design Tolerance Calibration), and full Capability Transfer Training. This phase integrates the engineered systems into live operational workflows and ensures that your internal teams are trained, certified, and capable of sustaining all systems independently. Handover documentation includes SOPs, calibration procedures, and CAPA Master Log templates.

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Phase II: Engineering Optimization

Duration: 4–10 Weeks

Hydraulic and thermal recalculation, datasheet reconstruction, HAZOP revalidation, and calibration system redesign. This is the core engineering phase where simulation data is translated into field-ready engineering documentation — pump datasheets, valve sizing calculations, exchanger thermal duty verifications, and HAZOP recommendation closures. All outputs are formatted for technical bid submission and regulatory audit readiness.

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Phase IV: Audit Readiness Certification

Duration: Continuous

Saudi Aramco pre-qualification, SASO/NCEC inspections, and annual governance reviews. Phase IV is not a one-time event — it is an ongoing governance relationship. ProQuESS provides continuous audit readiness support, annual system reviews, and pre-qualification documentation updates to ensure your organization maintains its operational and regulatory standing across all markets. This phase ensures that the investment in Phases I–III is protected and continuously validated.

- Each phase builds on the previous, ensuring that engineering optimization is never disconnected from quality governance and process safety — the three pillars operate as one system throughout the engagement lifecycle.

Verification vs. Assumption — Permanent Operating Systems That Protect Quality, Safety, and Operational Envelopes

The distinction between verification and assumption is the difference between an operation that is governed and one that is exposed. ProQuESS builds permanent operating systems — documented, auditable, and field-ready — that protect quality envelopes, safety envelopes, and operational envelopes simultaneously. These are not temporary fixes. They are engineered governance frameworks designed to withstand the scrutiny of Saudi Aramco technical bid evaluators, SASO/NCEC inspectors, US EPA auditors, and SABIC vendor qualification panels. Every system we deliver is built to the standard that your most demanding customer will apply to it.

US & GCC Operations Hub

Technical bid submissions, vendor pre-qualification, and North American engineering support. Our US & GCC hub serves as the primary point of contact for organizations operating in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, wider GCC markets, and the United States. We support technical bid preparation, Saudi Aramco and SABIC vendor pre-qualification, and North American engineering documentation to the standard required by the most demanding process industry clients in these markets.

Contact: +1 (336) 253-7234

North Africa Technical Hub

Engineering audits and laboratory system implementation across North Africa. Our North Africa hub delivers on-site engineering audits, laboratory quality system implementation, and ISO/IEC 17025 alignment across Sub-Saharan and North African markets. We support organizations navigating the regulatory and technical requirements of African process industries — from refinery modernization programs to fertilizer and specialty chemical operations.

Contact: +20 115 128 2137

NORTH AFRICA

SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

Corporate Credentials Summary

Core Disciplines	Process Engineering, Quality Management Systems, EHS & Process Safety Frameworks
Simulation Platforms	Aspen Plus, Aspen HYSYS
Standards Portfolio	API 610/ISO 13709, ASME B31.3, ASME Sec. VIII Div. 1, ISA-75/IEC 60534, TEMA, ISO 9001, ISO/IEC 17025, IEC 61882, SAES, SABIC
Vision 2030-Aligned Markets	Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, GCC, United States of America, North & Sub-Saharan Africa
Sector Focus	Refining, Petrochemicals, Fertilizers, Specialty Chemicals, Water Treatment, Heavy Process Industries

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Integrated Pillars

Process Engineering [Pro], Quality Management [Qu], and EHS & Safety [ESS] — operating as one system

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Engagement Phases

Diagnostic Audit, Engineering Optimization, System Integration, and Continuous Audit Readiness

10+

Governing Standards

API, ASME, ISA, IEC, ISO, TEMA, SAES, and SABIC — full standards portfolio coverage

4:1

Test Uncertainty Ratio

Mandatory TUR for all critical instrumentation under the Smart Equipment Criticality Matrix